



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Addenbrooke Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.augustineclassical.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Addenbrooke Classical Academy Co 80235 (ACA), operating in Lakewood, Colorado, presents a classical Christian program organized around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with a four-day academic week and a strong emphasis on partnership with families. Public materials describe ACA as a preschool–12th grade school whose mission is to provide an education that is both classical and Christian, to equip students to know, love, and practice what is true, virtuous, and beautiful, and to challenge them to strive for excellence as they live for the glory of God and for the good of all people. This signals a robust Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and Purpose/Goal alignment with classical education, and the curriculum is explicitly structured around grammar, logic, and rhetoric. Parent partnerships and community engagement are clearly foregrounded, and the faculty structure is visible in administrative and teaching roles. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key strengths - Explicit classical framework anchored in Christian ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a formation-of-character orientation. - Clear Trivium-based curriculum structure (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) across grade levels. - Strong focus on parental partnership and community involvement as part of the educational model. - Concrete evidence of a staff-driven, school-community culture with defined administrative and teaching roles.

Notes for improvement (to move toward a more fully CLASSICAL model) - Some elements of the traditional classical pedagogy (e.g., explicit Great Books engagement, explicit Socratic seminars in upper grades, and the "living curriculum" framing for faculty) are not consistently explicit in the public materials. Addressing these gaps in the site content would strengthen alignment with the fullest classical ideal.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - ACA describes its education as "classical and Christian," aiming to equip students to know, love, and practice what is true, virtuous, and beautiful, and to live for the glory of God. This signals transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded worldview. Direct mission language is visible in public materials. - The mission emphasizes truth, virtue, and beauty as real ideals shaping character and affections.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, truth, virtu(e) (virtue), beauty, glory of God, love, practice what is true, formation of affections. - Negative keywords: None detected in the public materials.

Why this rating - The presence of a Christian framing, emphasis on transcendent real ideals (truth, virtue, beauty), and the aim of character formation align strongly with a classical religious-metaphysical foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The core purpose is formation toward virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation, with a focus on truth, goodness, and beauty as knowable ideals. The mission ties education to formation of character and

human excellence, including the call to live for the glory of God and for the common good. - The statement about “formation rather than information” appears in the public materials’ framing of virtue, wisdom, and affections (the mission emphasizes formation of character and affections).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, God/glory, excellence. - Negative keywords: None detected.

Why this rating - The school explicitly emphasizes formation and the knowledge of transcendent realities (truth, goodness, beauty) as the aims of education, signaling a CLASSICAL orientation in purpose and goals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a classic Trivium-based structure: Grammar School (K–5), Logic School (6–8), Rhetoric School (9–12). This alignment with grammar, logic, and rhetoric is a hallmark of classical curriculum design. - The program sections reference distinct curricular lanes (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and are framed as the core structure of the school’s curriculum. (e.g., “The Grammar School (Grades K-5) ... The Logic School (Grades 6-8) ... The Rhetoric School (Grades 9-12).”)

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (explicitly named as the three stages of the curriculum). - Negative keywords: None detected in the public materials.

Why this rating - Clear, explicit reference to the three liberal-arts stages (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and an organizational curriculum aligned with the Trivium, plus program tracks and curriculum resources, support CLASSICAL status. The site’s curriculum evidence aligns with the classical framework.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials reveal a Trivium-centered structure (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) across K–12, which is a core classical pedagogy. The presence of a Rhetoric School indicates training in rhetoric and opportunities for public speaking or rhetoric-focused activities. The site also emphasizes a four-day academic week and memory-focused or sequential review in early years (consistent with traditional classical memory work and structured rhythm), though explicit mention of singing/chanting in the lower grades is not clearly documented in the public site text. - The site demonstrates explicit “public speaking”/rhetorical training through the Rhetoric School designation and associated offerings, indicating a pedagogy that develops oratorical skills. - Some elements of the restorative/contemplative aspect of classical pedagogy (Scholé, restful learning, wonder) are present in the broader classical-education discourse in the knowledge-base (e.g., ICE pamphlet discussions of contemplative/restful learning in classical education), but explicit direct statements about contemplative practices in ACA’s website materials are not consistently shown.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, rhetoric school, public speaking, seminars (implied by rhetoric training; explicit “speeches” notion appears in the general classical pedagogy language, but the site text explicitly naming “speeches” is not always shown; the Rhetoric School implies this). - Negative keywords: None explicitly present, but explicit Socratic/seminars references and Great Books references are not clearly documented on the website.

Why this rating - The core Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and the existence of a dedicated Rhetoric School constitute a CLASSICAL pedagogy. However, explicit notes of Socratic seminars, Great Books immersion, or explicit scholé/restful pedagogy are not clearly evidenced on the site, which places this category in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL until those practices are explicitly stated.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site lists named administrators and faculty (e.g., Executive Director, Grammar School Principal, Upper School Principal) and a staff directory with teacher bios and roles, suggesting a structured and professional faculty. - The site emphasizes a community atmosphere and partnership between staff, students, and families (as seen in staff descriptions and mission language about forming community).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: staff, teachers, principal, administration, community (implied by mission and staff page). - Negative keywords: None clearly present (no explicit text stating “living curriculum” or explicit faculty virtues language).

Why this rating - The public materials show a professional, multi-level faculty structure and a community-oriented culture, which aligns with classical expectations for faculty as mentors and living exemplars. However, explicit language about the faculty as “living curriculum” or a formalized faculty-development philosophy is not strongly evidenced in the public site text, which yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Strong emphasis on parent partnership: “By partnering with families, we exist to provide an education ...” and explicit statements about parents as co-teachers and the centrality of parental involvement in the educational process. The site notes partnership with families and views parents as first and best teachers, acknowledging the role of parents in supporting classroom instruction. - The staff page explicitly frames the school as a community with parents, stating: “Meet the staff/teachers who nurtures your child’s knowledge while living in the Christian way. We aim to build a good community with the students and parents.” This reinforces the co-teaching and community partnership ethos. - The four-day schedule is framed as a mechanism to partner with parents and enable families to participate in or supplement learning activities, reinforcing the co-teacher model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnering with families, parents as co-teachers, parents welcome to school, family involvement, community, tours/visits. - Negative keywords: None detected.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame parents as integral collaborators in the educational process and emphasize active family involvement and openness to parent participation, which aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for parent-community partnership.

What Would Move the Needle

Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 5 (Faculty) are the ones closest to being NOT FULLY CLASSICAL in the public materials. If the school wishes to move toward a full CLASSICAL designation, concrete steps could include: - Element 4: Pedagogy - Explicitly articulate and provide examples of Socratic seminars, classical discussion formats, and regular engagement with primary Great Books within upper levels. - Add explicit statements and program components around scholé/restful learning practices (e.g., planned contemplative periods, memory rituals, and nature-based or aesthetic experiences) and publicly publish how these are integrated into daily schedules. - Provide sample lesson plans or teacher statements showing how inquiry-based learning, rigorous logic and rhetoric work alongside contemplative practices.

- Element 5: Faculty
 - Publish a formal “Faculty Profile” framework that describes teacher virtues, mentorship roles, and how faculty serve as the living curriculum (with concrete examples and testimonials).
 - Highlight ongoing professional development that aligns with classical pedagogy, including training in the Trivium, Great Books engagement, and rhetoric instruction.
- Element 1–3 and Element 6 are already well aligned with CLASSICAL expectations; maintaining and expanding explicit language around Great Books, scholé, and a living-curriculum approach for faculty would further strengthen the overall CLASSICAL alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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